- Mapping is a mechanism for creating field schema definitions up front. Elasticsearch consults the schema definitions while indexing documents so the data is analyzed and stored for faster retrieval.
- Elasticsearch also has a default mapping feature: we can let Elasticsearch derive the mapping rather than providing it explicitly ourselves. Elasticsearch determines the schema based on the first time it sees a field.
- Although dynamic mapping is handy, especially in development, if we know more about the data model, it is best to create the mapping beforehand.
- Elasticsearch provides a wide range of data types for text, Booleans, numerical values, dates, and so on, stretching to complex fields like joins, completion, geopoints, nested, and others.